these two bodies. By doing so, there is no doubt that a greater developmental purpose will be served.

Q. 5 Briefly describe the National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture.

Ans. Climate change has enormous implications for the natural resources and livelihood of the people. Various studies indicate that the key sectors in India such as the agriculture, water, natural ecosystem, biodiversity, and health are vulnerable to climate change. This is happening precisely at a time when it is confronted with huge development imperatives. The Indian Network for Climate Change Assessment (INCCA) released a report in November 2010 on assessment of the impact of climate change on key sectors and regions of India in the 2030s – agriculture being one among the four key sectors. The report warns of impacts such as sea-level rise, increase in cyclonic intensity, *reduced crop yield in rainfed crops, stress on livestock, reduction in milk productivity, increased flooding*, and spread of malaria. This called for urgency of action in reducing vulnerability to adverse impacts of climate change. India announced a National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC) in June, 2008 to realise it, which includes 8 National Missions.

The National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA) is among the 8 national missions which seeks to address issues regarding ‘sustainable agriculture’ in the context of risks associated with climate change. Major functions of the Mission have been defined as given below:

(i) devising appropriate adaptation and mitigation strategies for ensuring food security,

(ii) enhancing livelihood opportunities, and contributing to economic stability,

(iii) mainstreaming the adaptation and mitigation measures in R & D activities,

(iv) absorption of improved technology and best practices,

(v) creation of physical and financial infrastructure and institutional framework,

(vi) facilitating access to information and promoting capacity building,